

Cārvāka — MCQ Solutions

Option-specific explanations and examiner traps

Correct positions are independently randomized and reasonably balanced. The bank is coverage-derived, not quota- or cycle-derived.

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Coverage-derived diagnostic and transfer bank

Answer placement: every question has one explicit primary test cell. Correct positions have no fixed rotation, no equal-quota contract and no run longer than two.

MCQ 1

Coverage cell: The three names of the school

Consider the following statements.

1. *Lokāyata* is standardly explained as the doctrine of the ordinary world or of common people.
2. *Bārhaspatya* names the tradition of Bṛhaspati, whose attributed aphorisms survive as a complete work.
3. The derivations of *Cārvāka* from "to chew" or from "pleasant speech" are doxographical etymologies rather than settled history.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: it keeps the false survival claim in 2 while discarding the sound gloss of *Lokāyata* as the worldly or popular doctrine. - **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 promotes a founder legend into a surviving document, whereas the attributed *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and known only through quoted fragments. - **C:** Incorrect: including 2 converts a traditional founder attribution into textual proof and contradicts the school's central source problem. - **D:** Correct: 1 and 3 reproduce the two safe cautions — *Lokāyata* is the this-worldly or popular doctrine, and the *Cārvāka* etymologies are doxographers' explanations, not historical evidence.

Examiner trap 1: The *Bārhaspatya* label records who the tradition claims as founder; it never certifies that a complete *Cārvāka* scripture is available for quotation.

MCQ 2

Coverage cell: The exact sense of *Veda-rejecting* (*nāstika*)

In classical Sanskrit philosophical classification, *Cārvāka* is called *nāstika* chiefly because it

- A. denies the reality of the perceptible external world along with its material objects and processes

- B. rejects Vedic authority as the primary criterion, while denial of post-mortem existence supplies a secondary sense
- C. denies a creator God, this being the primary test that separates orthodox from unorthodox systems
- D. accepts the authority of the Vedas while rejecting only the ritual apparatus that has grown around them

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the school affirms the perceptible world emphatically; its denials fall only on what cannot in principle be perceived. - **B:** Correct: the primary criterion of *nāstika* is rejection of Vedic authority; denial of life after death is a genuine but secondary sense in which the school also qualifies. - **C:** Incorrect: non-theism cannot be the classifying test, because classical Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā accept the Veda while not requiring a creator God. - **D:** Incorrect: the rejection reaches Vedic authority itself, not merely the ritual practices that authority sanctions.

Examiner trap 2: Translating *nāstika* flatly as "atheist" loses the Veda-authority criterion and wrongly makes non-theistic orthodox schools unorthodox.

MCQ 3

Coverage cell: The textual situation of the school

Which statement best describes the source position of Cārvāka philosophy?

- A. A complete *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives, accompanied by commentaries written within the materialist tradition itself.
- B. Nothing responsible can be said about the school, because every surviving witness to it is polemical and hostile.
- C. Mādhava's *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* is an authentic primary work composed by a Cārvāka teacher for his own school.
- D. No systematic primary materialist text survives, so reconstruction relies chiefly on convergent reports composed by philosophical opponents.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the attributed sūtra tradition is lost, and only scattered aphorisms and verses quoted by other authors remain. - **B:** Incorrect: hostility restricts confidence but does not abolish it, because independent opponents converge on the same doctrinal core. - **C:** Incorrect: the *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* chapter is a Vedāntin compendium's presentation of an opponent, valuable but not Cārvāka scripture. - **D:** Correct: reconstruction rests on convergent hostile testimony, which is why claims should be framed as the standard doxographical reconstruction.

Examiner trap 3: Writing that the sources are hostile is only half the point; the mark comes from adding that convergence across independent opponents still fixes a recoverable core.

MCQ 4

Coverage cell: The correct use of Jayarāṣi Bhaṭṭa

In an answer on Cārvāka, the *Tattvopaplavasīmha* of Jayarāṣi Bhaṭṭa is best used

- A. as a Nyāya refutation that attacks materialist epistemology from outside the tradition it describes, and therefore as hostile testimony of the ordinary doxographical kind
- B. as the surviving work commonly associated with the tradition and a contested sceptical limit-case that attacks even definitions of perception
- C. as the primary text that positively establishes perception as the sole independent means of valid knowledge, supplying the school with the systematic treatise it otherwise lacks
- D. as a Mīmāṃsā defence of the intrinsic authority of the Veda, written to protect ritual obligation against the epistemological criticisms pressed by the materialists

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: he is not a Naiyāyika; his dialectic dissolves Nyāya definitions rather than defending them. - **B:** Correct: he is the single surviving text-witness and simultaneously the internal limit-case, which is why his affiliation is discussed cautiously rather than assumed. - **C:** Incorrect: Jayarāṣi challenges the definability of perception as a means of valid knowledge, so he cannot be quoted to establish the school's defining thesis. - **D:** Incorrect: nothing in the work defends Vedic authority; his method is destructive of all definitional claims, orthodox and unorthodox alike.

Examiner trap 4: Using Jayarāṣi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis — perception alone is valid — that the standard school is defined by.

MCQ 5

Coverage cell: Why perception alone is admitted

The Cārvāka argument for restricting valid knowledge to perception proceeds by showing that

- A. perception is incapable of error, so no further source is needed to correct or supplement its deliverances at any point
- B. inference is acceptable while testimony is not, leaving perception and inference as the only two admissible independent sources of knowledge
- C. every cognition is fundamentally verbal, so perception must be treated as prior to the language in which knowledge is expressed
- D. inference exceeds what is immediately given, while testimony depends on inferred confidence in a speaker and therefore lacks independence

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: infallibility is not claimed; indeed the perceptual illusion counter-argument is later pressed against the school by its critics. - **B:** Incorrect: it concedes exactly what the school denies, since the rejection of inference as an independent source is the school's most famous thesis. - **C:** Incorrect: this is a thesis about language, not the epistemic-economy argument that actually generates the perception-only rule. - **D:** Correct: this is the two-step economy — only perception presents its object immediately, and every rival source is either derivative or unproved.

Examiner trap 5: The thesis is that perception is the *only independent* means of valid knowledge, which is far stronger than the uncontroversial claim that perception is the *primary* one.

MCQ 6

Coverage cell: Whether consciousness is denied

The statement "Cārvāka denies consciousness" is

- A. incorrect, because the school treats consciousness as an eternal quality inhering in a substance distinct from the living body
- B. correct, because consciousness is not one of the four admitted elements and therefore has no place in the ontology
- C. incorrect, because pleasure, pain and desire are internally perceived while an imperceptible bearer distinct from the living body is denied
- D. correct, because only externally perceived material objects are admitted as belonging to the perceptible world

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: an eternal quality inhering in a separate substance is precisely the Nyāya position the school is attacking. - **B:** Incorrect: consciousness is explained as a property of the organised elemental body, not eliminated from the world. - **C:** Correct: the school accepts the occurrence of awareness and rejects only the inferential addition of an immaterial possessor of it. - **D:** Incorrect: internal or mental perception of conscious states is expressly admitted alongside external perception.

Examiner trap 6: Denying a transcendental self is not denying awareness; scripts that merge the two lose the school's actual position on internal perception.

MCQ 7

Coverage cell: The attack on invariable concomitance

The central Cārvāka objection to inference is that invariable concomitance cannot be established because

- A. no inference has ever been observed to succeed, so the practice has no record of reliability to appeal to
- B. universals do not exist, so no relation obtaining between two universals can be stated or known in the first place

C. finite perception cannot establish universal *vyāpti*, inference would be circular or regressive, and testimony has no independently proved authority

D. the probans and the probandum are never in fact observed together, so no concomitance is available for generalisation at all

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the school concedes that inferences often succeed and argues instead that success is accidental rather than warranting. - **B:** Incorrect: denying universals is a Buddhist strategy; the Cārvāka objection is epistemic, about how the relation could be known. - **C:** Correct: this is the three-doors argument, and stating it as three closed routes rather than a vague "cannot be proved" is what earns marks. - **D:** Incorrect: the co-observation of smoke and fire is granted; the dispute concerns the leap from finite co-observation to an unrestricted universal.

Examiner trap 7: Reducing three distinct closed routes to one sentence about uncertainty is the commonest way of throwing away the marks in this argument.

MCQ 8

Coverage cell: The hidden limiting condition

The *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* argument establishes that

A. observed constancy may depend on an unnoticed condition and therefore fail to be unconditional

B. universal relations become secure automatically once a sufficiently large number of positive instances is collected

C. inference must be rejected because the conclusion drawn from a general rule is invariably found to be false

D. a decisive counter-instance has already been observed against every universal that has so far been proposed

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the wet-fuel qualification shows that what looked like a bare universal may have been conditioned all along. - **B:** Incorrect: this is the position under attack, since accumulation of positive cases is exactly what the objection says is insufficient. - **C:** Incorrect: falsity of conclusions is not asserted, and many inferences are admitted to reach true conclusions accidentally. - **D:** Incorrect: no such empirical claim is made; the argument is about what observation can guarantee, not about actual refutations.

Examiner trap 8: This is a structural objection about unnoticed qualifiers, not a complaint that too few instances have been counted.

MCQ 9

Coverage cell: Why verbal testimony is refused

Verbal testimony is denied the status of an independent means of valid knowledge because

- A. moving from an utterance to its truth requires inferred confidence in the speaker's competence and honesty, which words cannot certify
- B. words are conventional signs and therefore convey no determinate meaning that could be true or false at all
- C. the Veda is held to be authorless, and an authorless composition can carry no intelligible content for a hearer
- D. language is incapable of guiding practical action, so nothing said can ever be acted upon by a rational agent

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: testimony collapses into inference plus trust, so it cannot be rescued once inference has been denied independent validity. - **B:** Incorrect: meaning is not denied; the school accepts ordinary communication and denies only its independent epistemic warrant. - **C:** Incorrect: authorlessness is rejected as unproved, not treated as a source of unintelligibility. - **D:** Incorrect: pragmatic reliance on what people say is conceded; usefulness is separated from the status of a means of valid knowledge.

Examiner trap 9: Rejecting testimony as a means of valid knowledge is not rejecting language, and a script that confuses the two invites the charge of caricature.

MCQ 10

Coverage cell: Comparison, postulation and non-cognition

Applying the Cārvāka criterion to comparison (*upamāna*), postulation (*arthāpatti*) and non-cognition (*anupalabdhī*) yields which result?

- A. All three survive as independent sources, because none of them depends on the universal relation that inference presupposes and each rests on a distinct cognitive act.
- B. All three survive as independent sources, because each of them terminates directly in a fresh perceptual presentation of the object whose knowledge is being claimed.
- C. Each either presents only what perception already delivers, adding nothing independent, or moves beyond perception through an unproved universal and inherits the objection to inference.
- D. Only non-cognition survives, because the absence of an object is itself given directly in a single act of perception without any conditional reasoning being required.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: postulation excludes alternatives by a general rule and non-cognition uses a universal conditional, so both do depend on the disputed move. - **B:** Incorrect: if they terminated in perception they would add nothing independent, which is the first half of the dilemma rather than an escape from it. - **C:** Correct: the dilemma is exhaustive, though this systematic extension is a reconstruction rather than a claim that a surviving Cārvāka text refutes each later category by name. - **D:** Incorrect: "if the object were here it would be perceived" is a universal conditional, not the content of one perception.

Examiner trap 10: Present the extension to the larger catalogue as systematic reconstruction; asserting that a surviving Cārvāka work separately refuted each later category is unsupported.

MCQ 11

Coverage cell: How Nyāya rebuilds concomitance

Which set correctly lists the Nyāya devices for establishing invariable concomitance?

- A. Scriptural authority, the intuition of the accomplished yogin, and the reported statement of a person accepted as reliable by the community
- B. An exhaustive enumeration of every past, present and future instance, secured by a survey that no finite observer has yet completed
- C. The postulation of an unseen moral force that guarantees the stability of the regularity across all the cases not yet examined
- D. Agreement in presence and absence, removal of suspected conditions, supportive *tarka*, and later Nyāya perception of universal characters

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: scripture and yogic intuition are not the Nyāya route to concomitance, which is built from ordinary observation and reasoning. - **B:** Incorrect: complete enumeration is the impossible standard the Cārvāka demands, and Nyāya's reply consists precisely in abandoning it. - **C:** Incorrect: an unseen moral force is a Mīmāṃsā-style postulate and would concede the Cārvāka charge that the universal rests on the imperceptible. - **D:** Correct: positive and negative correlation, elimination of suspected conditions and supportive reasoning replace omniscient survey with disciplined procedure.

Examiner trap 11: Supportive reasoning is not itself a means of valid knowledge; it removes doubt and cannot by itself establish the relation, and saying so keeps the answer balanced.

MCQ 12

Coverage cell: The self-refutation charge

The charge of self-refutation against Cārvāka is most precisely stated as follows.

- A. A materialist cannot live consistently, because the necessities of eating, drinking and social life already presuppose a moral order.

- B. The universal denial of inference is not delivered by one perception, so defending that denial appears to require the reasoning rejected.
- C. The rejection of the Veda is inconsistent, because the very Sanskrit in which the rejection is stated is a Vedic inheritance.
- D. The ethics of pleasure contradicts the metaphysics of four elements, because pleasure is not itself an element in that list.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: this is a practical taunt, not the internal inconsistency that makes the philosophical charge severe. - **B:** Correct: the thesis quantifies over all inferential acts, and universality is exactly what perception alone cannot supply. - **C:** Incorrect: a linguistic genealogy establishes nothing about the epistemic status of the doctrine being asserted. - **D:** Incorrect: pleasure is treated as a state of the organised body, so no contradiction with the elemental ontology arises here.

Examiner trap 12: The charge is that the position is internally unstable, which is far stronger than the familiar and much weaker complaint that it is impractical.

MCQ 13

Coverage cell: Practical inference and accidental truth

Which formulation best preserves the refined Cārvāka position on everyday inference?

- A. Everyday inference must be surrendered together with all reasoning about what is absent, since a consistent materialist can appeal to nothing whatever beyond present sensation.
- B. Everyday inference establishes unseen entities whenever it succeeds repeatedly, so accumulated success gradually converts a practical habit into demonstrative and certain knowledge.
- C. Worldly inference is a corrigible expectation answerable to later perception, whereas transcendence-bearing inference lacks any possible perceptual check.
- D. Everyday inference is a genuine means of valid knowledge in worldly matters, while inference employed in scriptural argument alone is disqualified as invalid and unwarranted.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: this is the caricature the refined reading is designed to avoid, and it makes ordinary life unintelligible. - **B:** Incorrect: accumulating success is habit-formation, and the school's whole point is that habit never matures into certainty. - **C:** Correct: this keeps action possible, locates the real target in unredeemable inference, and blocks the appeal to predictive success. - **D:** Incorrect: granting the status of a means of valid knowledge in one domain surrenders the thesis, since status is not domain-relative.

Examiner trap 13: The distinction between practical usability and the status of a means of valid knowledge is the hinge of the refined reading; omitting it makes the answer look naïve.

MCQ 14

Coverage cell: Where Cārvāka sits in the ledger of knowledge sources

Arranged by the number of independent means of valid knowledge admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka one · Nyāya two · Sāṃkhya four · Advaita three, with testimony counted only where scripture is decisive
- B. All classical schools admit exactly three, differing only in the names they give to those three sources
- C. Cārvāka one · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism two · Sāṃkhya-Yoga three · Nyāya four · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā five · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita six
- D. Cārvāka two · Nyāya three · Mīmāṃsā four · Advaita five, with comparison counted only inside the Mīmāṃsā tradition

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Sāṃkhya admits perception, inference and testimony, and Advaita is placed above Nyāya, not below it. - **B:** Incorrect: the number of admitted sources is precisely what the schools dispute, from one up to six. - **C:** Correct: Cārvāka occupies the lower bound of a shared ledger, which is why every richer epistemology must justify its additions against it. - **D:** Incorrect: it credits Cārvāka with two sources and understates Advaita, which is standardly assigned the fullest list.

Examiner trap 14: Presenting Cārvāka as an eccentric outlier misses the structural point that it fixes the minimum against which every other school defends its additions.

MCQ 15

Coverage cell: The elemental scheme

Which statement about the Cārvāka account of the elements is correct?

- A. Earth, water, fire and air are admitted as perceptible elements, while *ākāśa* is rejected because its alleged substrate-role is inferred.
- B. Three elements are accepted, since air is treated as a rarefied condition of fire and water rather than as an independent element with a sensible quality of its own.
- C. Four elements are accepted and *ākāśa* is retained as a non-substantial medium that accommodates bodies without itself counting as one of the material elements.
- D. Five elements are accepted, including *ākāśa*, because the perception of sound requires an imperceptible substratum in which the quality of sound can inhere.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the fourfold scheme follows from the criterion, and refusing an imperceptible substratum for sound is the reason usually given. - **B:** Incorrect: no reduction of air is reported; the disputed element is *ākāśa*, and the count in question is four against five. - **C:** Incorrect:

retaining *ākāśa* in any form readmits an imperceptible item that the criterion excludes. - **D:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika inference, and it is exactly the move the perceptual criterion disallows.

Examiner trap 15: Writing "five elements" is the single most punished factual slip in this topic, because five is the standard number in most other Indian systems.

MCQ 16

Coverage cell: Evidence for the body-self

Which evidence is characteristically used to identify the self with the living body?

- A. First-person bodily predicates such as being stout or thin, together with the absence of any separately perceived self, support the body-self.
- B. A subtle body is perceived departing at the moment of death, which shows that personhood is exhausted by material organisation.
- C. Scriptural passages are cited in which the self is expressly identified with the gross body rather than with an inner controller.
- D. Memory-continuity is inferred to require a persisting substance, and that substance is then identified with the physical organism.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: identity-language plus the absence of any separately encountered self supplies a perceptual, non-inferential case for the body-self. - **B:** Incorrect: no such perception is claimed, and a departing subtle body would concede survival after death. - **C:** Incorrect: scriptural support would be self-defeating for a school that denies testimony the status of a means of valid knowledge. - **D:** Incorrect: this argues from an inference, whereas the school's strength here is its refusal to add an unperceived bearer.

Examiner trap 16: The opponent's reply that "my body" separates possessor from possessed must be met by noting that possessive grammar does not by itself prove a separate substance.

MCQ 17

Coverage cell: The betel and fermentation analogies

The betel and fermentation analogies are offered in order to show that

- A. consciousness is identical with one of the four elements taken singly, most often with the element of fire in the living body
- B. consciousness is an eternal quality of a separate self that the body merely manifests when the sense organs are in working order
- C. the elements are severally conscious already, though their consciousness remains unnoticed until they enter a bodily combination

D. an organised combination can display a novel property absent from its separate ingredients, so awareness need not require an immaterial bearer

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the analogies work precisely because the novel property belongs to none of the ingredients taken singly. - **B:** Incorrect: manifestation of a pre-existing quality is the rival account that the emergence claim is designed to replace. - **C:** Incorrect: attributing latent consciousness to each element abandons emergence and concedes a form of panpsychism. - **D:** Correct: red colour from betel ingredients and intoxicating power from fermenting agents illustrate emergent properties of an organised whole.

Examiner trap 17: The honest qualification is that emergence is asserted rather than explained, since redness and intoxicating power are third-personal while awareness is first-personal.

MCQ 18

Coverage cell: The four materialist identifications of the self

Sadānanda's *Vedāntasāra* reports four materialist positions distinguished by what each takes the self to be. Which set is correct?

- A. Gross body, subtle body, causal body and the witnessing consciousness that underlies all three of them
- B. The body, the intellect, the store of past actions and the liberated condition attained after their exhaustion
- C. Gross body, the sense faculties, the vital processes, and the internal mental organ
- D. The body, the accumulated moral residue, memory, and the desire that binds a person to future births

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: this is the Vedāntic sheath-and-witness scheme, which posits exactly the transcendent principle materialists reject. - **B:** Incorrect: moral residue and liberation are among the entities the school denies, so they cannot appear as materialist candidates. - **C:** Correct: body, senses, vital processes and mind exhaust the reported list, and each candidate perishes with the living complex. - **D:** Incorrect: it imports rebirth-machinery into a taxonomy whose whole point is that no candidate survives bodily dissolution.

Examiner trap 18: This fourfold list classifies the proposed bearer of personhood and must not be confused with the later crude-versus-refined contrast between types of Cārvāka.

MCQ 19

Coverage cell: The denial of transcendent entities

The opponent-preserved formula "death itself is liberation" is best read as

- A. a verse from surviving Cārvāka scripture that formally defines liberation for the materialist school

- B. a positive description of a blissful post-mortem condition attained once the body has been dissolved
- C. a denial of any positive release: bodily dissolution ends the person and therefore ends experienced suffering
- D. a claim that liberation is produced by the correct performance of funerary ritual at the moment of death

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the formula is preserved by opponents, and no Cārvāka scripture survives from which it could be quoted. - **B:** Incorrect: any positive post-mortem state would reinstate the survival the school denies on perceptual grounds. - **C:** Correct: the phrase is deflationary, cancelling the goal rather than describing an attainment. - **D:** Incorrect: the school's ritual critique is directed against exactly this kind of claim about unseen ritual results.

Examiner trap 19: Quoting the formula as a Cārvāka definition of liberation reverses its sense, since it abolishes the category instead of filling it.

MCQ 20

Coverage cell: Own-nature and accidentalism

Which statement correctly distinguishes explanation by own-nature (*svabhāvavāda*) from accidentalism (*yadr̥cchāvāda*)?

- A. Explanation by own-nature rejects transcendent causation while preserving natural regularity, whereas accidentalism denies determinate causation and is contestably attributed.
- B. Both are orthodox doctrines about an unseen causal order which the materialists rejected in favour of a purely perceptual account of how natural processes come about.
- C. Both deny causation entirely, so the two terms are interchangeable labels for a single Cārvāka doctrine about the natural world and the regularities that are observed in it.
- D. Explanation by own-nature denies all causation, while accidentalism preserves observed regularity by grounding it in chance conjunctions among the four admitted material elements.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: thorn-sharpness and the peacock's colours illustrate real regularities explained immanently, whereas accidentalism dissolves determinate causation. - **B:** Incorrect: neither is an orthodox doctrine, and accidentalism is criticised by Buddhists, Jainas and Naiyāyikas alike. - **C:** Incorrect: own-nature explanation retains causation and merely refuses to ground it in an unseen moral or divine order. - **D:** Incorrect: the two positions are reversed, since it is accidentalism, not own-nature, that abandons determinate causation.

Examiner trap 20: Attribute own-nature explanation to Cārvāka as its mainstream principle, and flag the accidentalist association as contested rather than asserting it.

MCQ 21

Coverage cell: The structure of Cārvāka ethics

Which statement best expresses the ethical position of the school?

- A. Duty grounded in scripture is retained as a social necessity while liberation alone is rejected as an unverifiable transcendent goal.
- B. Immediate gratification is to be maximised without any weighing of consequence, since consequences lie in a future that cannot be perceived now.
- C. Pleasure and wealth are co-equal ultimate ends of human life, and neither is subordinate to the other in the ordering of goods.
- D. Pleasure is the end and wealth its instrument, while foreseeable pain calls for prudent selection rather than renunciation of embodied enjoyment.

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: scripturally grounded duty is rejected along with liberation, since both rest on the sources already denied. - **B:** Incorrect: reckless indulgence is the hostile caricature, and the reported incorporation of statecraft and economics tells against it. - **C:** Incorrect: the two are expressly ranked, wealth being valuable only in so far as it sustains enjoyment. - **D:** Correct: this is prudential hedonism, and the husk-and-grain image is the standard reply to the objection that pleasure always carries pain.

Examiner trap 21: The reported inclusion of statecraft and livelihood in the Lokāyata curriculum is thin doxographical evidence; present it as suggestive of a secular social theory, not as established.

MCQ 22

Coverage cell: Cārvāka and the Jaina conception of reality

Which contrast between the two conceptions of reality is accurate?

- A. Cārvāka admits perceptible material particulars, whereas Jainism admits enduring plural substances described through standpoint-conditioned and many-sided predication.
- B. Cārvāka admits plural substances including souls, while Jainism reduces all reality to a single conscious principle that appears as many.
- C. Both restrict reality to matter, differing only over whether the number of material elements is four or five.
- D. Both accept an unchanging reality behind appearances, differing only over whether that reality can be known by perception.

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the contrast runs through the means of knowledge, substance, self and liberation, not merely through the slogan of matter against spirit. - **B:** Incorrect: the positions are inverted, since souls are plural in Jainism and denied altogether in Cārvāka. - **C:** Incorrect: Jaina reality includes conscious substance, so the disagreement is not a dispute about counting elements. - **D:** Incorrect: Cārvāka posits no reality behind appearances, and Jaina persistence-through-change is not an unchanging substratum.

Examiner trap 22: Reducing this comparison to "materialism versus spiritualism" forfeits the marks that come from arguing it across knowledge, substance, self and liberation.

MCQ 23

Coverage cell: Whether the school is positivistic

Which is the strongest reason for qualifying the label "positivistic" when it is applied to Cārvāka?

- A. Cārvāka accepts scriptural testimony in a restricted practical form, whereas positivism excludes revelation altogether from the domain of statements that can count as knowledge.
- B. Positivism depends on scientific inference and law-like explanation, whereas Cārvāka denies inference the status of a means of valid knowledge, so a shared anti-metaphysical spirit conceals opposite methods.
- C. The term is modern and Western, so any comparison between it and a classical Indian school is illegitimate in principle and can only distort both sides of the comparison.
- D. Positivism admits an immaterial self as the subject of experience, whereas Cārvāka identifies the person with the living body and allows no bearer beyond it.

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: scriptural testimony is rejected outright, so this cannot be the point of divergence. - **B:** Correct: the agreement is about what may be admitted, and the disagreement is about the very inferential machinery on which science runs. - **C:** Incorrect: controlled comparison is legitimate and is even used in the standard expositions, provided it is offered as analogy rather than identity. - **D:** Incorrect: positivism does not require an immaterial self, so this supposed contrast does not exist.

Examiner trap 23: A flat yes or a flat no both lose marks here; the demand invites a graded verdict that concedes the empiricist temper and refuses the inferential identification.

MCQ 24

Coverage cell: Two refusals of the self

Which statement correctly differentiates the Cārvāka refusal of a transcendental self from the Buddhist rejection of a self?

- A. Cārvāka denies the self while Buddhism affirms an eternal self that survives the dissolution of the aggregates at death and carries the moral record forward into a further life.

B. Both denials are identical in content and differ only in the technical vocabulary that each tradition happens to employ when it states its rejection of an enduring self.

C. Cārvāka denies transcendence but keeps a material bearer, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality, retains causal continuity, and rejects material form as self.

D. Buddhism identifies the person with the physical body while Cārvāka denies that any bearer of personhood exists at all, whether that bearer is conceived as material or as immaterial.

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: an eternal self is exactly what the Buddhist doctrine of not-self is formulated to reject. - **B:** Incorrect: the two denials rest on different arguments and yield different consequences for rebirth and moral continuity. - **C:** Correct: the Buddhist analysis is wider, not weaker, because it dismantles the very identification the Cārvāka retains. - **D:** Incorrect: the positions are reversed, since it is Cārvāka that keeps a bearer and makes it material.

Examiner trap 24: Writing that both schools "deny the self in the same way" collapses a twenty-mark comparison into a one-line similarity and cannot recover the marks.

MCQ 25

Coverage cell: How the Nyāya devices divide their work

Which statement most accurately separates the functions of the principal Nyāya replies to the Cārvāka challenge?

A. *Anvaya-vyatireka* searches positive and negative cases, *upādhī*-elimination qualifies the relation, and *tarka* removes doubt without itself becoming a *pramāṇa*

B. *Anvaya-vyatireka* proves every future case, *upādhī* names the conclusion, and *tarka* supplies direct perception of the universal

C. *Tarka* alone establishes *vyāpti*, while positive and negative instances merely illustrate a certainty already obtained through testimony

D. *Upādhī*-elimination rejects all qualifications, while *anvaya-vyatireka* replaces inference with an exhaustive survey of every possible case

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the devices have distinct jobs, and supportive reasoning removes a blocking doubt rather than independently producing knowledge. - **B:** Incorrect: Nyāya claims disciplined warrant, not omniscient coverage, and neither *upādhī* nor *tarka* has the role assigned here. - **C:** Incorrect: *tarka* is explicitly a helper of a means of knowledge, while observed correlations and condition-removal do substantive evidential work. - **D:** Incorrect: eliminating a suspected condition refines the universal, and positive-negative testing does not pretend to enumerate every possible instance.

Examiner trap 25: Listing the devices without separating their functions hides the exact point at which Nyāya changes certainty into disciplined warrant.

MCQ 26

Coverage cell: Ākāśa, sound and the burden of naturalisation

What is the strongest balanced assessment of the Cārvāka rejection of *ākāśa* as the substrate of sound?

- A. The rejection is decisive because sound is never perceived, so no material process can account for its occurrence
- B. The rejection consistently blocks an inferred substrate, but it must still naturalise sound through perceptible air or material processes rather than merely dismiss it
- C. The rejection accepts the Vaiśeṣika substance-quality argument but denies only that *ākāśa* is eternal and all-pervasive
- D. The rejection follows because Cārvāka admits five elements while treating *ākāśa* as a temporary combination of the other four

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: sound is perceived; the disputed claim concerns the imperceptible substance proposed as the bearer of that perceived quality. - **B:** Correct: epistemic economy removes the inferred substrate, while explanatory adequacy requires a positive material account of sound. - **C:** Incorrect: once the substance-quality inference is accepted, the characteristic Cārvāka reason for excluding *ākāśa* has already been surrendered. - **D:** Incorrect: the school admits four perceptible elements and rejects, rather than recombines, the fifth element proposed by its opponents.

Examiner trap 26: Do not confuse perception of sound with perception of an imperceptible sound-substrate; they are different claims.

MCQ 27

Coverage cell: Remedial drill — own-nature against unseen moral force

"Fire burns by its own nature" differs from "fire burns because of an unseen moral factor" because

- A. both statements appeal to transcendent causation and differ only in the vocabulary that each of them happens to choose for the cause
- B. The first ends explanation with an observable natural property, while the second adds an imperceptible moral force beyond the perceptual criterion.
- C. the first appeals to divine will while the second appeals to an impersonal physical law that governs combustion wherever it occurs
- D. the first denies that any regularity obtains in nature, whereas the second affirms regularity and offers an account of its stability

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: only the second appeals to something transcendent; the first is deliberately immanent. - **B:** Correct: the contrast is between an immanent stopping point and a supersensible postulate. - **C:** Incorrect: divine will belongs to neither, and the unseen moral factor is not an impersonal physical law. - **D:** Incorrect: regularity is affirmed by own-nature explanation, which is what separates it from accidentalism.

Examiner trap 27: Concede the fair objection that "by its own nature" can look like a placeholder, then answer it by noting that every explanatory chain terminates somewhere and this terminus is at least observable.

MCQ 28

Coverage cell: The epistemology-to-transcendence chain

Which sequence best reconstructs why Cārvāka epistemology generates its rejection of transcendent entities?

- A. Only perception is independently valid; soul, God, karma, rebirth and heaven are not perceived; their inferential or scriptural routes fail; therefore they lack warranted admission
- B. Materialism is accepted first on scriptural grounds; perception is then restricted so that the prior ontology cannot be challenged by rival schools
- C. Ethical hedonism is established first; all unseen entities are rejected only because they might impose limits on immediate pleasure
- D. The four elements are inferred as universal causes; every other inference is then rejected because it competes with that preferred causal theory

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the denials are the ontological shadow of the perception-only rule, not an unrelated list of anti-religious conclusions. - **B:** Incorrect: Cārvāka rejects scriptural authority, and the direction of derivation runs from epistemology toward ontology rather than backwards. - **C:** Incorrect: ethics follows the removal of unseen goods and sanctions; it does not supply the foundational argument against them. - **D:** Incorrect: treating the elements as products of the very unrestricted inference being attacked would make the system immediately self-defeating.

Examiner trap 28: A list of denials earns less than the single derivational chain that explains why each denial follows from the same epistemic criterion.

MCQ 29

Coverage cell: Remedial drill — the crude and refined contrast

How should the crude and refined (*dhūrta* and *suśikṣita*) contrast be used in an answer?

- A. As another name for the fourfold taxonomy of materialist identifications of the self that Vedāntic sources report and classify

- B. as an opponent-preserved crude/refined contrast whose refined form supplies a possible response to the charge of practical self-refutation
- C. As a modern scholarly invention with no basis in the Indian doxographical literature through which the school has been transmitted
- D. As two securely attested Cārvāka schools with surviving texts, named teachers and datable institutional histories running in parallel

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: that taxonomy classifies the bearer of personhood, a different question altogether. - **B:** Correct: the safe formula is that later doxographers distinguish a crude from a refined form, though the evidence is indirect. - **C:** Incorrect: the contrast is genuinely reported in the doxographical literature, even though it is transmitted by opponents. - **D:** Incorrect: no surviving Cārvāka text confirms two schools with fixed doctrines, and the labels vary across doxographies.

Examiner trap 29: Over-documenting this contrast as institutional history is as damaging as ignoring it, because the source base cannot carry that weight.

MCQ 30

Coverage cell: Remedial drill — what survives of the attributed aphorisms

What survives of the aphorisms attributed to Bṛhaspati?

- A. Nothing whatever, so that not even a single quoted line can be attributed to the tradition with any confidence
- B. No continuous primary text survives, but scattered aphorisms and verses remain in works that usually quote them while mounting refutations.
- C. The complete work, together with at least one commentary composed within the materialist tradition itself
- D. A condensed summary chapter, written by a Cārvāka author for the instruction of students of the school

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: quoted fragments do survive, and denying them overstates the loss and paralyses the answer. - **B:** Correct: about a dozen aphorisms and verses are quoted by others, which is why reconstruction is cautious but not impossible. - **C:** Incorrect: no such work or commentary is extant, which is the root of the school's reconstruction problem. - **D:** Incorrect: the well-known summary chapter is by a Vedāntin compiler presenting an opponent's view.

Examiner trap 30: Both overstatements fail here — claiming a surviving treatise, and claiming that nothing at all survives.

MCQ 31

Coverage cell: Remedial drill — the status of the pleasure verse

How should the verse "as long as one lives, let one live happily", with the associated line about incurring debt, be handled in an answer?

- A. As a word-for-word quotation from the surviving aphorisms of Bṛhaspati, and therefore as decisive documentary evidence
- B. As the school's official ethical formula, sufficient on its own to describe the whole of Cārvāka moral philosophy
- C. as a traditional doxographical verse associated with the school, not as a quotation secured by an extant Cārvāka primary text
- D. As a Mīmāṃsā parody of materialism with no genuine connection to the Lokāyata tradition at any point

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: no extant primary text exists from which a verbatim quotation could be taken. - **B:** Incorrect: treating a slogan as the complete ethics reproduces the caricature that the refined reading exists to correct. - **C:** Correct: the verse may be used for colour and framing provided its transmission status is stated honestly. - **D:** Incorrect: the verse is genuinely transmitted in association with the tradition, even though its provenance is doxographical.

Examiner trap 31: Quoting the verse is safe; presenting it as scripture, or as the school's entire ethical theory, is not.

MCQ 32

Coverage cell: Karma and *adṛṣṭa* are related but not identical

Which statement correctly distinguishes *karma* from *adṛṣṭa* in the Cārvāka critique?

- A. *Karma* concerns morally charged action and its consequences, while *adṛṣṭa* is the unseen potency or residue invoked to connect action with later fruition
- B. *Karma* is the perceptible body, while *adṛṣṭa* is the internally perceived consciousness that qualifies that body
- C. *Karma* means ordinary physical causation, while *adṛṣṭa* means the observable regularity explained through a thing's own nature
- D. *Karma* and *adṛṣṭa* are interchangeable names for rebirth, so rejecting either one independently completes the entire argument

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the concepts belong to one moral-causal scheme but name different components, both of which fail the Cārvāka perceptual test. - **B:** Incorrect: body and consciousness belong to the materialist account of the person, not to this distinction within moral causation. - **C:** Incorrect: ordinary causation and *svabhāva* are naturalistic ideas, whereas *adṛṣṭa* is precisely the imperceptible factor being rejected. - **D:** Incorrect: rebirth is a further doctrine requiring a surviving bearer and continuity, not a synonym for either moral action or unseen potency.

Examiner trap 32: Writing “karma or *adṛṣṭa*” as if the words were synonyms erases the mechanism the opponent is actually proposing.

MCQ 33

Coverage cell: Why perception cannot establish vyāpti

Why does finite perception fail, on the Cārvāka argument, to establish the universal “wherever smoke, there is fire”?

- A. Because smoke and fire are never perceived together in any ordinary case
- B. Because perception supplies only universals and cannot reach particular fires
- C. Because the relation is false whenever fire burns without producing visible smoke
- D. Because observed cases are finite and cannot include every past, present, future, near and distant instance required by an unrestricted universal

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: co-presence in kitchens and hearths is granted; the problem concerns extending those observations without limit. - **B:** Incorrect: ordinary perception presents particulars, while the opponent must explain how an unrestricted universal becomes known through them. - **C:** Incorrect: fire without smoke does not refute the one-way rule from smoke to fire, although it matters to careless formulations. - **D:** Correct: no finite survey can by itself entail an exceptionless relation covering cases that were never and may never be perceived.

Examiner trap 33: The quantitative weakness is not that observation has found no support, but that finite support cannot equal unrestricted universality.

MCQ 34

Coverage cell: Why inference cannot establish its own vyāpti

What happens if inference is used to prove the *vyāpti* required for inference?

- A. The proof becomes perceptual because every inferential premise is ultimately a sensation
- B. The proof succeeds if its conclusion is repeated by several competent speakers
- C. The proof becomes comparison because the new universal resembles the original one

D. The proof is circular if it presupposes a universal, or regressive if each supporting inference requires a further universal

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: an inferential transition does not become perception merely because some premises originated in perceptual experience. - **B:** Incorrect: multiplying testimony does not remove the need to justify the inference from reported cases to a universal relation. - **C:** Incorrect: resemblance does not supply the exceptionless connection that the attempted proof must establish. - **D:** Correct: inference cannot non-circularly certify the universal warrant on which its own validity already depends.

Examiner trap 34: Name both horns: presupposing *vyāpti* is circular, while proving it through another inference opens a regress.

MCQ 35

Coverage cell: Why testimony cannot establish *vyāpti*

Why can testimony not rescue the universal premise of inference on the Cārvāka account?

- A. Because every utterance is meaningless until its speaker is physically present
- B. Because accepting the speaker's authority already requires inferred reliability, and dependence on testimony would prevent a person from inferring independently
- C. Because testimony can establish only moral duties and never statements about ordinary objects
- D. Because authorless testimony is accepted, while authored testimony is rejected as necessarily deceptive

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: meaningful communication is conceded; the dispute concerns truth-warrant rather than the existence of linguistic meaning. - **B:** Correct: testimony cannot ground inference without borrowing inference to establish reliability and making independent reasoning impossible. - **C:** Incorrect: the restriction is not a subject-matter division between moral and ordinary claims, but an objection to independent epistemic authority. - **D:** Incorrect: Cārvāka rejects the alleged privilege of authorlessness and does not declare every human speaker necessarily deceptive.

Examiner trap 35: The testimony route fails twice: it borrows inference to certify the speaker and cannot explain autonomous inference by the hearer.

MCQ 36

Coverage cell: Illusion and the *tu-quoque* correction problem

An opponent notes that a shell may look like silver and that later reasoning corrects the error. What is the most accurate assessment of this challenge?

- A. The *tu quoque* proves that every perception is false and therefore establishes testimony as the only reliable source

- B. It is irrelevant because Cārvāka defines perception as whatever cognition cannot possibly be corrected
- C. It is a *tu quoque* pressure: Cārvāka may distinguish appearance from corrected perception, but explaining correction often relies on comparison or inference that the school demotes
- D. It refutes only Jayarāśi, because standard Cārvāka denies that perceptual illusion ever occurs

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: the *tu quoque* label does not make all perception false or confer automatic authority on testimony. - **B:** Incorrect: defining away correction would be circular and would not explain how a mistaken presentation is identified as mistaken. - **C:** Correct: the *tu quoque* exposes a correction problem without proving that perception and inference have identical epistemic status. - **D:** Incorrect: standard Cārvāka need not deny illusion, while Jayarāśi uses such definitional difficulties more radically against every proposed *pramāṇa*.

Examiner trap 36: The objection is strongest as a correction challenge, not as the crude claim that one illusion abolishes all perception.

MCQ 37

Coverage cell: Universals and the *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* response

How does Nyāya's appeal to *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* answer the Cārvāka objection concerning universals?

- A. It concedes that universals are never known and replaces them with recurring private images
- B. It claims that a universal is presented through a perceived particular, though this reply depends on Nyāya realism about universals and is not neutral common ground
- C. It proves the universal by enumerating every individual that instantiates it across all times and places
- D. It treats universals as scriptural meanings disclosed only through authorless Vedic sentences

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Nyāya is realist about repeatable universals and does not reduce them to private mental imagery. - **B:** Correct: extraordinary perception is offered as access to the class-character, but its force depends on accepting the ontology under dispute. - **C:** Incorrect: exhaustive enumeration is neither possible nor Nyāya's proposed account of how a universal becomes cognitively available. - **D:** Incorrect: the response belongs to Nyāya perception theory, not to a Mīmāṃsā doctrine of Vedic disclosure.

Examiner trap 37: State both halves: the response blocks the Cārvāka premise inside Nyāya, yet cannot compel someone who rejects real universals.

MCQ 38

Coverage cell: The exact defect in the Socrates syllogism

For the 2019 Q6(c) argument “All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; therefore Socrates is mortal,” where does the Cārvāka locate the defect?

- A. The form is valid, but the universal major premise is not independently warranted; deduction merely extracts what the unproved premise already contains
- B. The conclusion is invalid because a singular subject can never occur in a deductive argument
- C. The minor premise is false because the historical existence of Socrates cannot be perceived now
- D. The argument equivocates on mortality by changing its meaning between the major premise and the conclusion

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the attack concerns the epistemic acquisition of “all men are mortal,” not the conclusion's formal derivation from accepted premises. - **B:** Incorrect: singular terms occur in valid deductions, and this response misses the universal-premise problem tested by the PYQ. - **C:** Incorrect: the example assumes the minor premise and asks what is wrong with the inferential warrant supplied by the major premise. - **D:** Incorrect: no semantic equivocation is required for the Cārvāka criticism, which targets induction and circular deduction.

Examiner trap 38: Calling the syllogism formally invalid is the decisive error; the Cārvāka says it is valid but epistemically empty.

MCQ 39

Coverage cell: Jayarāṣi's *prasaṅga* and no-positive-thesis strategy

Which formulation best captures Jayarāṣi's strongest reply to the charge that scepticism uses the reasoning it rejects?

- A. He establishes four elements as a positive theory and uses them to deduce that all rival definitions are false
- B. He suspends ordinary transactions until a final criterion of truth has been discovered
- C. He uses *prasaṅga* to expose consequences within an opponent's definitions without advancing a rival positive thesis, allows ordinary transactions to continue, yet still owes an account of the dialectical norms used
- D. He accepts Nyāya inference for debate while rejecting it only in private philosophical reflection

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: this would restore dogmatic materialism and expose him directly to the self-refutation charge he is trying to evade. - **B:** Incorrect: the surviving account says ordinary dealings continue even after theoretical foundations are dialectically unsettled. - **C:** Correct: no-positive-thesis *prasaṅga* reduces commitment, while the residual question concerns the authority of the destructive norms themselves. - **D:** Incorrect: using Nyāya inference as independently valid would abandon rather than refine the sceptical strategy.

Examiner trap 39: A sophisticated answer preserves all four parts: internal consequence, no rival thesis, continuing practice, and the residual norm problem.

MCQ 40

Coverage cell: Ordinary communication versus independent testimony

How can a Cārvāka consistently respond to ordinary verbal directions such as “water is beyond the grove”?

- A. By treating every utterance as direct perception of the distant object described
- B. By accepting the speaker as infallible whenever the statement concerns practical life
- C. By relying on the report provisionally for action while withholding independent *pramāṇa* status until perception confirms or defeats it
- D. By denying that the sentence has meaning but following its sounds through conditioned reflex

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: hearing words is perceptual, but the distant water they describe is not thereby presented to perception. - **B:** Incorrect: practical subject matter does not make a speaker infallible or eliminate the need to assess reliability. - **C:** Correct: ordinary communication can guide corrigible action without becoming an independent guarantee of the reported fact. - **D:** Incorrect: Cārvāka rejects testimonial authority, not semantic understanding or purposive linguistic interaction.

Examiner trap 40: The key distinction is practical uptake versus independent truth-warrant, not meaningful speech versus meaningless noise.

MCQ 41

Coverage cell: Vedic authorlessness, infallibility and authority

Why does alleged Vedic authorlessness fail to establish infallible authority for Cārvāka?

- A. Because an authorless text must have been composed by a creator God whose reliability cannot be tested
- B. Because only authored texts can possess grammatical meaning and communicate ritual commands
- C. Because authorlessness proves that no priest has ever interpreted the text for personal advantage
- D. Because neither authorlessness nor freedom from error is perceptually given, and the text cannot certify its own authority without circularity

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: appealing to a creator would add another imperceptible entity and does not follow from the Mīmāṃsā claim of authorlessness. - **B:** Incorrect: intelligible meaning does not by itself require an identifiable human author, and this is not the Cārvāka's central objection. - **C:** Incorrect: the history of interpretation is separate from the epistemic question whether the text is intrinsically error-free. - **D:** Correct: the privileged status is precisely what requires proof, so citing the Veda to validate the Veda is question-begging.

Examiner trap 41: Do not argue merely that some priests are unreliable; target the claimed bridge from authorlessness to intrinsic infallibility.

MCQ 42

Coverage cell: Comparison as a separate proposed pramāṇa

What is the specific Cārvāka-style objection to *upamāna* as an independent means of knowledge?

- A. Resemblance is never perceived, so comparison contains no perceptual component at all
- B. Comparison is valid only when a Vedic sentence supplies the objects being compared
- C. Every comparison is a deductively valid syllogism and therefore needs no separate treatment
- D. Perceived resemblance is admitted, but moving from it to a stable word-kind relation requires generalisation beyond the presented likeness

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: perceived similarity is the admitted starting point, so denying it would misstate the reconstructed objection. - **B:** Incorrect: ordinary comparison does not depend on scripture, and importing Vedic authority evades the epistemic issue. - **C:** Incorrect: *upamāna* is proposed as a distinct cognition, and reducing it to deduction does not explain the word-kind acquisition. - **D:** Correct: either perception already supplies the content or the classificatory step inherits the disputed universalising move.

Examiner trap 42: Keep *upamāna* separate: its distinctive pressure point is the move from a seen resemblance to a stable linguistic classification.

MCQ 43

Coverage cell: Postulation as a separate proposed pramāṇa

Why does *arthāpatti* fail the Cārvāka test of independent knowledge?

- A. It reports a perceived absence and therefore never posits anything beyond the observed facts
- B. It introduces an unperceived fact as necessary, but that necessity depends on a general rule excluding every alternative explanation
- C. It derives certainty from resemblance between two perceived objects

D. It is valid only for explaining sacred injunctions and has no ordinary examples

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: postulation is invoked precisely because the explanatory fact is not presented in the observations already available. - **B:** Correct: the alleged compulsion of the postulate outruns perception and relies on an unproved universal exclusion of alternatives. - **C:** Incorrect: resemblance is associated with comparison, not with explanatory postulation under apparent inconsistency. - **D:** Incorrect: the standard examples include ordinary explanatory postulates, so the objection cannot be confined to scripture.

Examiner trap 43: The target is not imaginative guessing but the claim that one unperceived explanation is uniquely necessitated.

MCQ 44

Coverage cell: Non-cognition as a separate proposed pramāṇa

What hidden premise does the Cārvāka expose in the claim “the jar is absent because it is not perceived here”?

- A. If the jar existed under suitable conditions, it would be perceived; that universal conditional is not itself contained in the present non-perception
- B. Every absent object must exist in another place at the same moment
- C. A jar can be known only through testimony from its maker
- D. Absence is a material element that combines with earth to produce empty space

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the move from not-seeing to absence depends on a visibility conditional that one episode of non-cognition does not establish. - **B:** Incorrect: non-cognition does not entail relocation, and the theory of absence makes no such universal commitment. - **C:** Incorrect: ordinary jar perception does not require testimony, and the proposed inference concerns visibility conditions. - **D:** Incorrect: absence is not one of the four elements and is not treated as a material ingredient of spatial emptiness.

Examiner trap 44: Write the conditional explicitly; without it, the inference from non-perception to absence looks falsely immediate.

MCQ 45

Coverage cell: Parāmarśa and the alleged inferential leap

What role does *parāmarśa* play in the Nyāya reply to Cārvāka?

- A. It is the first perception of smoke before any universal relation is considered

- B. It is the cognition of the present mark as qualified by known *vyāpti*, applying the universal to the case rather than making an unexplained leap
- C. It is testimony from a reliable person that the conclusion has already been proved
- D. It is the hidden condition whose discovery defeats the proposed universal relation

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: merely seeing the mark is insufficient; the inferential trigger includes its qualification by the remembered universal relation. - **B:** Correct: *parāmarśa* explains the application stage linking the observed sign, established concomitance and present conclusion. - **C:** Incorrect: the cognition belongs to the inferer's reasoning and is not a report received from another speaker. - **D:** Incorrect: an *upādhi* limits a universal, whereas *parāmarśa* is the case-directed cognition used in a sound inference.

Examiner trap 45: Do not list *parāmarśa* as another method of discovering *vyāpti*; it applies an already known relation.

MCQ 46

Coverage cell: Nyāya warrant versus entailment

What is the fairest verdict on whether Nyāya defeats the Cārvāka problem of induction?

- A. Nyāya supplies disciplined defeasible warrant through testing and condition-removal, but finite evidence still does not deductively entail an unrestricted universal
- B. Nyāya proves every universal with mathematical entailment and therefore eliminates any possibility of a future defeating case
- C. Cārvāka wins completely because rational warrant is worthless unless it equals omniscient certainty
- D. The dispute disappears once both schools agree that successful prediction retrospectively makes every inference infallible

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: judged by warrant Nyāya has a strong reply, while judged by entailment the residual Cārvāka point remains. - **B:** Incorrect: the Nyāya procedure is disciplined but does not turn finite observation into deductive coverage of all possible cases. - **C:** Incorrect: this simply assumes the Cārvāka's infallibilist standard instead of evaluating whether knowledge may be defeasible. - **D:** Incorrect: predictive success supports reliability but cannot retroactively guarantee that no hidden condition or future exception exists.

Examiner trap 46: The highest-value verdict names the standard: Nyāya wins on warrant, Cārvāka survives on entailment.

MCQ 47

Coverage cell: Transmigration requires both a survivor and karmic continuity

Which reconstruction states the full Cārvāka criticism of transmigration tested in 2020 Q6(b)?

- A. Transmigration fails only because heaven and hell are spatially too distant to be perceived during embodied life
- B. It requires a self that survives bodily death and a karmic mechanism carrying desert into another birth; Cārvāka denies perceptual warrant for both links
- C. It is rejected because Cārvāka accepts an immortal soul but denies that it can enter more than one body
- D. It is rejected solely because scripture gives mutually inconsistent descriptions of the next birth

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: distance is not the complete issue, since the doctrine also requires personal survival and moral-causal transmission. - **B:** Correct: without both a surviving bearer and karmic continuity, there is no subject or mechanism for transmigration. - **C:** Incorrect: body-self materialism denies the separate immortal survivor assumed by this option. - **D:** Incorrect: textual disagreement may reinforce doubt, but the core criticism independently removes the ontology and causal bridge.

Examiner trap 47: Do not reduce transmigration to generic afterlife denial; identify both the surviving subject and the karmic connector.

MCQ 48

Coverage cell: God, the potter analogy and svabhāva

How does Cārvāka answer the inference from an ordered world to God as its intelligent maker?

- A. By accepting the potter analogy and identifying the creator with a perfected human artisan
- B. By arguing that every perceived effect has no cause and that nature is wholly chaotic
- C. By proving through scripture that the world is eternal and therefore cannot have any maker
- D. By rejecting the unproved transfer from pots to the world and preferring *svabhāva*, observable natural powers and regularities, over an imperceptible designer

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: enlarging a familiar artisan does not justify applying the artifact model to the world as a whole. - **B:** Incorrect: *svabhāva* preserves natural regularity and differs from the claim that events are wholly causeless. - **C:** Incorrect: scripture cannot establish the anti-theistic conclusion for a school that denies its independent authority. - **D:** Correct: the analogy is inferentially unsupported, while own-nature offers an immanent stopping point without a transcendent potter.

Examiner trap 48: Separate rejecting a cosmic potter from rejecting ordinary causation; Cārvāka naturalism need not be accidentalism.

MCQ 49

Coverage cell: Heaven and hell as unverified postulates

What is the direct Cārvāka objection to heaven and hell?

- A. They are perceived only by priests and therefore remain valid for ritual specialists
- B. They are not perceptually available and are reached through the same disputed scriptural or inferential routes used for post-mortem reward and punishment
- C. They are material places accepted by Cārvāka but denied any moral function
- D. They are rejected because pleasure and pain cannot occur in any embodied organism

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: privileged priestly perception is not conceded and would require independent evidence of the claimed access. - **B:** Correct: the locations and their moral functions depend on unverified testimony, inference and the afterlife scheme already under attack. - **C:** Incorrect: accepting the places while removing their moral role is not the standard materialist position reported by the sources. - **D:** Incorrect: embodied pleasure and pain are central perceived facts in Cārvāka ethics and psychology.

Examiner trap 49: Treat heaven and hell as distinct unseen destinations within the moral scheme, not as mere synonyms for rebirth.

MCQ 50

Coverage cell: Veda, sacrifice, ancestral offerings and priestcraft

How should an answer use Cārvāka attacks on sacrifice and ancestral offerings?

- A. As proof that ridicule alone establishes the falsity of every ritual claim
- B. As a concession that rituals work, although priests distribute their benefits unfairly
- C. As historical evidence that Cārvāka accepted Vedic authority but opposed expensive ceremonies
- D. As satire illustrating the critique of priestly interest, while the philosophical argument remains that unseen ritual results lack perceptual or independently warranted support

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: mockery may expose tension but cannot replace the epistemic argument against unseen causal results. - **B:** Incorrect: the polemic denies that the promised supersensible benefits have been established in the first place. - **C:** Incorrect: rejection reaches Vedic authority and the

alleged ritual mechanism, not merely the price of ceremonies. - **D:** Correct: the ancestral-offering and sacrificial-victim taunts are illustrations; the warrant argument does the philosophical work.

Examiner trap 50: Distinguish argument from satire: priestcraft explains suspicion, but failed epistemic warrant supports the conclusion.

MCQ 51

Coverage cell: Memory and personal identity

What is the strongest balanced treatment of memory as an objection to the Cārvāka body-self?

- A. Memory seems to require continuity of the remembering subject; Cārvāka may invoke bodily and causal continuity, but must explain identity through change without an immaterial bearer
- B. Memory directly perceives a disembodied soul and therefore conclusively refutes every material account of persons
- C. Memory is impossible on Cārvāka because the school denies that consciousness ever occurs
- D. Bodily continuity automatically proves numerical identity, so memory raises no explanatory problem at all

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: the objection presses persistence, while the reply offers embodied causal continuity but leaves a genuine explanatory burden. - **B:** Incorrect: memory presents past content, not a separate substance perceived apart from the body. - **C:** Incorrect: the school accepts consciousness and internal experience while locating them in the organised living body. - **D:** Incorrect: bodily persistence through material change requires argument and cannot simply be treated as self-evident proof of identity.

Examiner trap 51: A balanced answer neither declares memory a direct perception of soul nor pretends bodily continuity needs no theory.

MCQ 52

Coverage cell: Jaina and Vedāntic objections to emergent consciousness

Which pairing accurately distinguishes two objections to Cārvāka's emergence account of consciousness?

- A. Jainism denies every enduring bearer, while Vedānta explains awareness as a chemical property of the gross body
- B. Jainism and Vedānta both accept emergence but disagree only about which material element produces awareness
- C. Jainism objects that matter cannot preserve karmic bondage without *adr̥ṣṭa*, while Vedānta accepts the body as self-luminous

D. Jainism posits a conscious *jīva* as bearer, while Vedānta argues that self-luminous consciousness is the condition for knowing material states rather than their emergent product

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Jainism affirms plural enduring souls, while Vedānta refuses to reduce consciousness to bodily chemistry. - **B:** Incorrect: both traditions reject the materialist emergence thesis at a more basic metaphysical level. - **C:** Incorrect: the Jaina bearer is the *jīva*, and Vedānta treats consciousness rather than the body as self-luminous. - **D:** Correct: the objections differ, one supplying an enduring bearer and the other reversing the dependence between matter and awareness.

Examiner trap 52: Do not collapse rival objections into one: Jainism defends a bearer, while Vedānta defends consciousness as epistemically prior.

MCQ 53

Coverage cell: Science and the induction transfer

What is the most defensible modern transfer of the Cārvāka challenge to scientific induction?

- A. Science is invalid because every theory contains terms that are not directly visible to the unaided senses
- B. Scientific success proves that observed regularities entail exceptionless laws with no possibility of revision
- C. Finite evidence underdetermines unrestricted universals, so science answers through testable, revisable and probabilistic warrant rather than claiming apodictic entailment
- D. Cārvāka anticipated every modern scientific theory and should therefore be treated as an early experimental scientist

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: instruments, causal testing and indirect evidence can remain empirically answerable without being unaided visual perception. - **B:** Incorrect: successful prediction strengthens warrant but does not convert inductive support into deductive entailment. - **C:** Correct: the transfer preserves the induction problem while recognising that scientific rationality is fallibilist and methodologically self-correcting. - **D:** Incorrect: a useful structural parallel does not license anachronistic attribution of later theories or experimental institutions.

Examiner trap 53: Use the comparison to illuminate fallibilism, not to turn Cārvāka into either an anti-scientist or a modern scientist.